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&
INSTITUTIONS INNOVATION COUNCIL

Business Process Innovation (BPI) Industry Visit

Submitted by

Harsita S

7376232CB122

BANNARI AMMAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY – INSTITUTION'S INNOVATION COUNCIL

&

Industry Exploration and Collaboration Cell

Duration: 28/03/2026 – 03/04/2026

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ABOUT THE STUDENT

S.NO	Description	Details
1.	Name of the student	Harsita S
2.	Register Number	7376232CB122
3.	Department	CSBS
4.	Year of study	III
5.	Contact Number	78262834624
6.	Mail id	harsita.cb23@bitsathy.ac.in
7.	Location	Gobichettipalam

Local Context – BPI Industry Visit (Basic Details)

Parameter	Details
Organization / Industry Name	**Sakthi Rice mill**
Location (City / Area)	**Gobichettipalam**
Date of Visit	**02/04/2026**
Time of Visit	**4:30pm**
Department / Unit Visited	**Rice Processing unit**
Industry Contact Persons	***Mr. Rajendran K & Owner***

Photographic Evidence	*(Attach link)*

Relevant SDG Aligned with Industry Operations: SDG 9 – Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure

DAY 1 ORIENTATION, OVERVIEW & THE BIG PICTURE

BPI – SECTION 1 BUSINESS OVERVIEW & END-TO-END FLOW

1.1 Core Purpose

Product/Service	Category	Variants	Problem Solved	Customer Impact
Raw Rice	Manufacturing	Ponni, Sona Masoori, Kolam	Need for clean, edible rice	Provides quality staple food
Broken Rice	Manufacturing	Small-size grains	Affordable option for customers	Cost-effective consumption
Rice Bran	By-product Sales	Bran for cattle feed	Waste reduction	Useful for farmers & mills
Husk	Manufacturing	Boiler fuel	Energy requirement	Reduces energy cost

Category: ☑ Manufacturing ☐ Service ☐ Trading ☐ Hybrid

Additional Remarks:

Sakthi Rice Mill specializes in rice processing, including cleaning, dehusking, polishing, grading, and packing. The mill supplies local wholesalers, retailers, and rice traders.

1.2 Revenue Model

Revenue Source	Description	Pricing Method	Frequency	% Contribution
Rice Sales	Selling processed rice	Per kg	Daily	75%
By-product Sales	Husk & bran sold to cattle-feed units	Per load	Weekly	15%
Wholesale Orders	Bulk rice bags to traders	Discount pricing	Monthly	10%

Main Revenue Driver: Processed Rice Sales

Additional Remarks:

Rice bags (25kg / 50kg) sold to wholesalers form the core income source. By-products offer steady additional revenue.

1.3 Customer Profile

Segment	Characteristics	Needs	Source Channel
Retailers	Repeated buyers	Consistent supply	Direct call, Weekly
Wholesalers	Bulk purchasers	Competitive pricing	Direct visit , Monthly

Local Consumers	Small quantity	Quality rice	Walk-in, As needed
Cattle Feed Units	Buy bran & husk	Bulk quantity	Agreement-based, Weekly

Customer Type: ☑ B2B ☑ B2C ☐ Both

Additional Remarks:

Major customers are wholesalers, while local

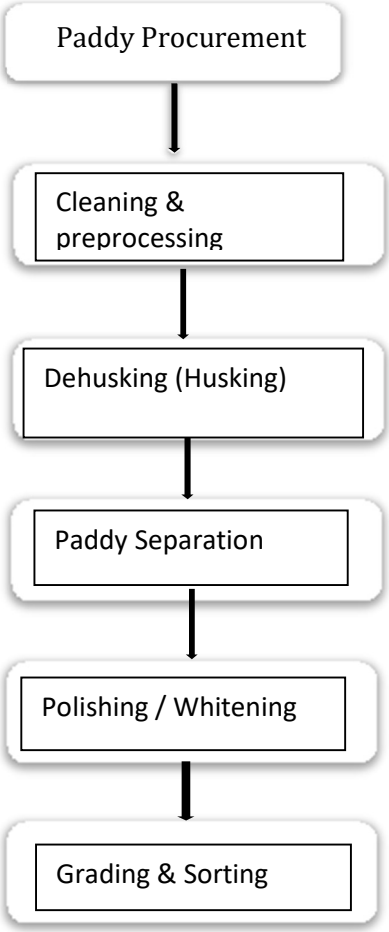
consumers purchase smaller packs.

1.4 Department Map

Department	Role	Depends On	Outputs To
Raw Paddy Procurement	Buying paddy	Farmers / suppliers	Cleaning Unit
Cleaning Unit	Removes stones, dust	Raw Paddy	Dehusking
Dehusking	Removes husk	Clean Paddy	Polishing

Polishing Unit	Adds shine & smoothness	Brown Rice	Grading
Grading	Sorts rice by size	Polished Rice	Packing
Packaging	Bagging 10kg/25kg/50kg	Graded Rice	Storage
Storage & Dispatch	Ready dispatch	Packed Bags	Customers

Draw Flow Diagram Below:



Additional Remarks:

The entire brick-making process, from the procurement of soil to the final fire, is done by hand. Before moulding, soil is mixed with water to achieve proper consistency, which is a critical step affecting brick quality. In a kiln, bricks are stacked atop fuel and strengthened by heat produced from below. The kiln structure uses underground firewood burning, which ensures uniform heating of bricks. Particularly during the drying phase, labor and weather conditions have a major role.

1.5 Single Unit Trace

Step No	Department	Activity	Input	Output	Time Taken	Waiting Time
1	Procurement Paddy purchase	Raw paddy	Stored paddy	Soil available	1 month - 2 month	Depends upon gov permission
2	Cleaning	Dust & stone removal Paddy	Soil, water	Wet clay mixture		Depends on soil availability
3	Dehusking	Husk removal	Clean paddy	Brown rice		
4	Polishing	Whitening rice	Brown rice	White rice		Depends on weather
5	Grading	Size separation	White rice	Sorted rice		1 – 2 days

6	Packing	Bagging	Graded rice	Packaged rice	2 – 5 days	No major wait
7	Delivery	Dispatch to buyers	Packed bags	Customer order	1 – 2 days	Based on order

Additional Remarks:

The single unit trace shows the complete journey of brick production from raw soil to final delivery. The process involves multiple stages with significant waiting time, especially during drying and firing. Weather conditions play a crucial role in drying, and delays in any stage can affect the entire production flow.

1.6 Time at Each Step

Covered in above table

Additional Remarks:

The time taken for each step varies based on labor availability and environmental conditions. The drying and firing stages consume the most time in the process. Any delay in these stages directly affects overall production and delivery timelines.

1.7 Biggest Risk Point

Identify the most critical risk in the process:

Machine Breakdown & Moisture Variation

Reason:

Processing depends heavily on machinery and paddy moisture content. Incorrect moisture results in broken rice and quality issues.

Additional Remarks:

Soil is the primary raw material, and any disruption in its availability directly impacts production. Weather conditions, especially rain, create uncertainty in drying and firing, making the process highly vulnerable to environmental and regulatory factors.

1.8 Most Critical Task

Identify the most important task affecting success:
Paddy Moisture Checking & Polishing Process

Reason:

Improper moisture leads to increased broken rice percentage. Polishing directly affects rice appearance and market value.

Additional Remarks:

The kiln firing stage requires proper arrangement of bricks and controlled burning of firewood. Skilled labor and careful monitoring are essential to ensure uniform heating and good quality output.

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BPI – SECTION 2 (ROUTINE TASKS & DEPENDENCIES)

2.1 Daily Tasks

Task	Time of Day	System/Memory	Owner	Output	Risk if Missed	Backup Available (Y/N)
Paddy cleaning	Morning	Machine + Memory	Workers	Clean paddy	Poor quality rice	Y
Dehusking process	Morning–Afternoon	Memory	Workers	Raw bricks	No production output	Y
Polishing process	Afternoon	Memory	Workers	Bricks ready for drying	Delay in process	Y
Packaging	Full day	Memory	Workers	Properly dried bricks	Cracks / defects	N
Machine monitoring	full day	Memory	Manager	Ready for firing	Uneven burning	N

Additional Remarks:

Most daily operations in the rice mill are machine-based but require continuous monitoring by workers and the manager. Missing any step directly affects production quality and output. Machine operation is critical and lacks proper backup.

2.2 Weekly / Monthly Tasks

Task	Frequency	System/Memory	Owner	Output	Risk if Missed	Backup Available (Y/N)
Paddy procurement	| Weekly / Seasonal | Manual | Manager	Raw material stock	Owner	Raw material stock	Production stops completely	N
Machine maintenance	Weekly / Monthly	Memory	Owner	Firewood for kiln (dried wood)	Cannot perform firing	N
Equipment check	Weekly	Memory	Skilled workers	Proper firing setup	Uneven brick quality	N
Order planning	Weekly	Memory	Workers	Proper moulding	Defective bricks	Y

Storage management	Weekly	Manual	Workers	| Organized stock	Damage / confusion	Y

Additional Remarks:
Paddy procurement is a critical task and depends on seasonal availability. Machine maintenance is essential to avoid breakdowns, but it is not always regularly scheduled, creating operational risk.

2.3 System vs Memory Mapping

Task	Is Documented (Y/N)	Where Stored	Access Level	Error Risk
Cleaning process	N	worker memory	Workers	Medium
Machine operation	N	Operator knowledge	Limited	High

Order details	Y	Register	Manager	Low
Stock details	Y	Register	Manager	Low

Additional Remarks:
Most operational tasks rely on worker experience rather than proper documentation. Only administrative tasks like orders and stock are recorded, which reduces errors in those areas.

2.4 Task Ownership

Task	Primary Owner	Secondary Owner	Approval Required (Y/N)	Escalation Path
Cleaning process	Workers	Manager	N	Manager
Machine operation	Operators	Manager	Y	Manager
Packaging	Workers	Supervisor	N	Manager
Order handling	Skilled workers	Owner	Y	Manager

Labour management	Manager	Supervisor	Y	Manager

Additional Remarks:
Most operational tasks are handled by workers, while the manager controls decisions and approvals. Machine-related tasks require skilled operators, increasing dependency on specific individuals.

2.5 Impact if Task is Missed

Task	Immediate Impact	Downstream Impact	Customer Impact	Recovery Time
Cleaning process	Poor clay quality	Weak bricks formed	Low quality bricks supplied	1 day
Dehusking	No bricks produced	Entire process delayed	Delay in order delivery	2-3 days
Polishing	Bricks remain wet	Cannot proceed to firing	Delivery delay	1 day
Packaging	Bricks not hardened properly	Poor strength / breakage	Customer dissatisfaction	Same day
Machine maintenance	Cannot start firing	Production halted	Delay in supply	2-3 days

Additional Remarks:
Each task in the rice mill is interdependent. Missing any critical task, especially machine-related operations, can disrupt the entire production flow and affect delivery timelines.

2.6 Dependency Risk (Key Person Absence)

Task	Key Person	Can Others Perform (Y/N)	Time to Substitute	Risk Level (H/M/L)
Cleaning	worker	Y	Immediate	L
Machine operation	Skilled operator	Y	2–3 days	H
Packaging	Workers	Y	1 day	M
Order handling	Manager	N	5 days	H
Maintenance	Technician	N	5–7 days	H

Overall Dependency Level: ☑ High ☐ Medium ☐ Low

Additional Remarks:

The rice mill shows high dependency on skilled machine operators and the manager. Replacement takes time, making operations vulnerable if key persons are absent.

2.7 Handover Readiness

Task	Handover Document Exists (Y/N)	Steps Clearly Defined (Y/N)	Training Required	Time to Handover
Cleaning	N	N	Basic training	1–2 days
Basic training	N	N	Moderate training	2–3 days
Machine operation	N	N	Basic guidance	1 day
Skilled training	N	N	Skilled training	5–7 days
Packaging	N	N	Basic training	1–2 days
Basic training	Y	Y	Minimal training	1–2 days
Labour management	Y	Y	Minimal training	1–2 days

Additional Remarks:
Most tasks lack formal documentation and depend on experience. Skilled operations like machine handling require significant training, while administrative tasks are easier to transfer.

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BPI – SECTION 3 (LEAD & ORDER CAPTURE SYSTEM)

3.1 Inquiry Channels

Channel	Type (Online/Offline)	Volume	Handled By	Recorded (Y/N)	Risk
Phone calls	Offline	High	Manager	Y	Miscommunication
Direct visit (walk-in)	Offline	Medium	Manager	Y	Missed details

Local traders / referrals	Offline	High	Manager	N	Not properly tracked
WhatsApp	Online	Medium	Manager	Y	Messages may be missed

Additional Remarks:
Most inquiries in the rice mill are received through phone calls, direct visits, and local trader networks. While some details are recorded manually, others rely on memory, which increases the risk of missed follow-ups and lost business opportunities.

3.2 Recording System

Channel	Where Recorded	Format (Digital/Manual)	Accessible To	Error Risk
Phone calls	Register / Mobile	Manual / Digital	Manager	Medium
Direct visit (walk-in)	Notebook / register	Manual	Manager	Medium
WhatsApp	Mobile (chat history)	Digital	Manager	Low
local contacts	Not recorded / memory	None	Manager	High

Additional Remarks:

The rice mill mainly uses manual recording methods such as notebooks and registers. Some digital records exist through WhatsApp, but many inquiries (especially referrals) are not recorded properly, increasing the risk of missed information

3.3 Follow-up Process

Stage	Action	Responsible Person	Timeline	System Used	Miss Risk
Inquiry received	Customer contacts via phone / visit	Manager	Immediate	Phone / Direct	Low
Inquiry recording	Details written in notebook	Manager	Same time	Manual	Medium
Order confirmation	Price & quantity discussed	Manager	Same day	Verbal/Phone	Medium
Follow-up (if not confirmed)	Supervisor contacts customer again	Manager	1–2 days	Phone	High
Order finalization	Order is confirmed and scheduled	Manager	Same or next day	Manual	Low

Additional Remarks:
The follow-up process is mostly manual and depends on the manager. There is no formal system to track pending inquiries, which increases the chances of missing potential customers.

3.4 Lead/Order Tracking

Lead ID	Current Stage	Tracking Method	Updated (Y/N)	Visibility	Delay Risk
Order 1	Inquiry received	Register entry	Y	Manager	Medium
Order 2	Order confirmed	Manual (verbal + register)	Y	Manager	Low
Order 3	In production	Memory-based	N	Manager	High
Order 4	Ready for delivery	Visual check (stock)	N	Manager	Medium
Order 5	Delivered	Verbal confirmation	Y	Manager	Low

Additional Remarks:
The rice mill follows a basic manual tracking system. There is no unique ID system or digital tracking, and some stages depend on memory or visual checks. This reduces transparency and increases the risk of delays.

3.5 Lost Lead Evidence

Has any lead/customer inquiry been missed?

☑ Yes ☐ No

If Yes, fill below:

Case	Channel	Reason Missed	Detected How	Impact
1	Phone call	Forgot to note order details	Customer called again	Delay
2	Referral	Not recorded properly	No follow-up done	Lost customer
3	Direct visit	Miscommunication / no tracking	Customer did not return	Loss of business

Additional Remarks:
Most inquiries in the rice mill are received through phone calls, direct visits, and local trader networks. While some details are recorded manually, others rely on memory, which increases the risk of missed follow-ups and lost business opportunities.

3.6 Conversion Gap

Stage	Drop-off %	Reason	Improvement Opportunity
Inquiry → Order confirmation	20–30%	Price negotiation / delay in response	Faster response & clear pricing
Order confirmation → Production	10–15%	Lack of stock / raw material issues	Better planning & inventory management
Production → Delivery	10–20%	Delay due to weather (drying/firing)	Improve scheduling & backup planning

Additional Remarks:

Conversion gaps occur mainly due to delays in response, pricing issues, and production constraints such as weather dependency and raw material availability. Since there is no structured tracking or follow-up system, some inquiries do not convert into confirmed orders. Improving communication and planning can reduce these drop-offs.

3.7 Ideal Lead & Order System

Describe ideal process flow:

Customer inquiry is received through phone, direct visit, or online platforms. All inquiries are recorded in a centralized system (register or simple digital tool). Each inquiry is assigned a unique ID and tracked through different stages such as inquiry, confirmation, production, and delivery. Regular follow-up is done for pending inquiries. Order status is updated at each stage, and customers are informed about progress and delivery timelines.

Key improvements needed:

- Introduce a proper system for recording all inquiries
- Assign unique IDs for each order
- Maintain a follow-up system to avoid missed leads
- Use digital tools (Excel or mobile apps) for tracking
- Improve communication with customers regarding order status
- Plan production and delivery schedules more effectively

Additional Remarks:

Implementing a structured lead and order management system can reduce errors, improve customer satisfaction, and increase conversion rates. Even a simple digital solution can enhance tracking, visibility, and efficiency in operations.

BPI – SECTION 4 (STAKEHOLDER INTERACTIONS)

4.1 Owner – Biggest Risk

Owner Name	Role	Identified Risk	Why Critical	Impact Level
Manager	Owner	Machine failure & paddy price variation	Direct impact on production cost & output	High

Additional Remarks:

The owner identified major risks related to raw material availability and environmental conditions. Government restrictions on soil collection and weather dependency, especially rain, directly impact production and quality. These risks are beyond the control of the business, making them critical for operations.

4.2 Owner – Pride vs Concern

Aspect	Pride Area	Concern Area	Reason
Product Quality	Clean & well-polished rice	Moisture variation issues	Weather impacts drying and firing
Operations	Efficient machinery	Occasional breakdown	Manual process + weather dependency
Customer Relationship	Strong ties with wholesalers	Lack of digital order tracking	No proper follow-up system

Raw Material	Availability during permitted period	Soil shortage after period	Government restrictions

Additional Remarks:
The owner takes pride in producing quality bricks and maintaining good relationships with customers. However, concerns exist regarding weather dependency, delays in production, and raw material availability due to government restrictions. These challenges affect consistency and business growth.

4.3 Manager – Resource Constraint

Manager Role	Department	Resource Constraint	Impact	Frequency
Mr. Raja	Manager Processing Unit	Machine breakdown	Production stops completely	Occasional
Mr. Sakthi	Manager Raw Material	Limited paddy availability	Production delay/halt	Seasonal
Mr. Gobu	Labor	Unavailability of workers	Slows down operations	Occasional

Additional Remarks:

The rice mill mainly depends on machinery and continuous raw material supply. Any machine failure directly stops production. Paddy availability is seasonal, which creates dependency on procurement planning. Labour shortage also affects operations, but machinery plays a more critical role compared to manual industries.

4.4 Manager – Operational Gap

Process	Gap Identified	Cause	Impact	Suggested Fix

Order tracking	Manual	Manual recording / memory-based	Missed or delayed orders	Digital system
Maintenance	Irregular	Dependence on sunlight	Production delay	Schedule

Additional Remarks:

Several operational gaps were identified in the business, mainly due to lack of formal systems and dependency on manual processes. Issues such as poor tracking, weather dependency, and lack of planning affect efficiency and productivity. Implementing simple improvements can significantly enhance performance.

4.5 Frontline Worker – Shortcut Observation

Worker Role	Task	Shortcut Taken	Reason	Risk Level
Worker	Cleaning process	Skipping proper removal of small impurities	To save time	Medium
Worker	Packaging	Not weighing exact quantity	Faster packing	Medium

Skilled Worker	Machine operation	Ignoring minor machine issues	Reduce effort/time	High

Additional Remarks:

Frontline workers in the rice mill may take shortcuts due to workload and time pressure. Skipping proper cleaning can affect rice quality, while inaccurate packaging impacts customer trust. Ignoring minor machine issues can lead to major breakdowns, making it a high-risk factor in the production process.

4.6 Worker – Frustration

Worker Role	Task	Frustration	Cause	Impact
Worker	Cleaning process	Dust exposure	Continuous handling of raw paddy	Health issues / discomfort
Worker	Packaging	Repetitive work	Continuous packing process	Reduced efficiency
Skilled Worker	Machine operation	Noise and Heat exposure	Running heavy machinery	Health issues / fatigue
Worker	Material handling	Managing heavy loads even with forklift	Limited forklift availability / manual support still needed	Physical strain / slower movement

Additional Remarks:

Workers in the rice mill face challenges due to continuous machine operation and physical involvement in handling materials. Exposure to dust, noise, and heat affects their comfort and efficiency. Although machines reduce manual work, some tasks still require physical effort, leading to fatigue and reduced productivity.

4.7 Unimplemented Ideas

Stakeholder	Idea	Why Not Implemented	Feasibility	Expected Impact
Manager	Digital order tracking system	Lack of technical knowledge	High	Better tracking & reduced errors
Manager	Automatic cleaning & grading machines	High investment cost	Medium	Improves quality & speed
Workers	More automation in packaging	Cost constraint	Medium	reduces manual effort
Manager	Proper storage system for paddy	Space limitation	Medium	Avoid shortage issues
Manager	Regular machine maintenance system	Lack of planning	High	educes breakdowns

Additional Remarks:

Several improvement ideas are identified in the rice mill, but they are not implemented due to cost constraints, lack of technical knowledge, and space limitations. Implementing these ideas can improve efficiency, reduce dependency on manual work, and enhance overall production quality.

4.8 Stakeholder Summary Insights

Common patterns observed across stakeholders:

Most stakeholders depend on machine-based operations along with manual supervision. There is a strong dependency on continuous raw material supply (paddy) and proper machine functioning. Almost all stakeholders highlighted issues related to machine breakdown, lack of proper tracking systems, and operational inefficiencies. The absence of digital systems leads to delays and errors in order handling and production monitoring.

Conflicts between stakeholders:

Minor conflicts exist between workers and management due to workload and machine-related delays. Workers face fatigue due to continuous machine operation, while management focuses on maintaining production targets and timely delivery. Differences may arise when production pressure increases, especially during high-demand periods.

Alignment opportunities:

There is an opportunity to improve coordination by introducing simple digital systems for order tracking and production monitoring. Regular machine maintenance and better planning of raw material procurement can align both worker efficiency and management goals. Providing better working conditions can also improve productivity and reduce worker fatigue.

Additional Remarks:

Overall, the rice mill operates efficiently with the help of machinery, but lacks structured systems and proper planning. By implementing basic digital tools and improving maintenance practices, the business can enhance productivity, reduce risks, and improve stakeholder satisfaction.

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Mandatory for all (Day 1/ Day 1+2/Day 1+2+3)

FINAL SUMMARY

Top 3 Improvements:

1. Introduce digital order & inventory tracking to avoid manual errors.

2. Invest in moisture control systems to reduce broken rice percentage.

3. Set up semi-automatic bagging to reduce worker strain.

Conclusion:

The visit to Sakthi Rice Mill, Gobichettipalayam, provided a clear understanding of rice processing operations. The mill is efficient but depends heavily on manual monitoring at several points. Implementing simple improvements can increase productivity, reduce risks, and enhance product consistency

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Attachment Proofs:

Geotag Photo

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Podcast video URL

Declaration

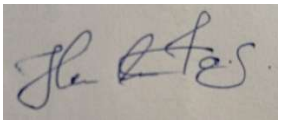
I confirm that the data in this report was collected in person on **02-04-2026** at **Gobichettipalayam** and verified with the official mentioned above.

All photographs were taken by me using my own device, and the names of individuals were recorded with their consent for academic purposes only.

Name: Harsita S

Department: CSBS – III Year

Register No.: 7376232CB122

Signature: 

Date: 02-04-2026

DISCOURSE

22CB502 & BUSINESS STRATEGY

1. Question
Assertion: Buyer experience should be the primary focus of ShopPlus's strategic management plan.
Reason: A superior customer experience directly correlates with increased brand loyalty and sales

Please select from the following expressions:
a) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion.
b) Both the assertion and the reason are false, and the reason correctly explains the assertion.
c) The assertion is true and the reason is false, and the reason correctly explains the assertion.
d) The assertion is false and the reason is true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion

2. Question

School of Thoughts for Strategic Formulation.

Demonstrate how the Learning School's approach could justify the need for flexibility in Industries strategy during the product launch.

3. Question

TechPro Industries faces a strategic dilemma between the Design and Learning Schools as it prepares to launch a new line of environmentally-friendly products. The Design School advocates for a top-down, deliberate strategy, where senior management crafts a plan based on a thorough SWOT analysis, ensuring a clear, focused direction for the product launch. In contrast, the Learning School supports a bottom-up approach, where strategy evolves through experimentation and adaptation, allowing the company to respond flexibly to market dynamics and unforeseen challenges. As the debate intensifies, TechPro must decide whether to commit to a well-defined strategy or embrace an adaptive, learning-driven approach that allows the strategy to emerge as the product line develops.

Show a strategic approach for TechPro Industries based on the scenario provided

4. Question

Rivian, an electric vehicle startup, has introduced its all-electric pickup truck, the R1T, into the U.S. market. This move has prompted established automakers like Ford and General Motors to accelerate their EV development plans, aiming to compete in the growing electric truck segment. Rivian's direct-to-consumer sales model and emphasis on adventure-oriented features have resonated with a specific customer demographic, challenging traditional automotive sales and marketing strategies.

Match the above Terms (A), with correct Definition (B) and Examples (C).

Terms (A)	Definitions (B)	Examples (C)
A1) Strategic Management	B1) The process of analyzing competitors to understand their strategies, strengths, and weaknesses	C1) Allocating budget towards R&D for electric vehicle development
A2) Competitive Analysis	B2) The systematic approach to planning, implementing, and monitoring an organization's strategy.	C2) Implementing a strategic plan to integrate EVs into the company's product lineup
A3) Consumer Trends	B3) The distribution and use of resources to achieve strategic objectives and operational efficiency.	C3) Ford is investing heavily in EV technology to compete with Tesla.
A4) Resource Allocation	B4) The practice of examining and responding to shifts in customer preferences and behavior.	C4) Analyzing data on increasing consumer demand for eco-friendly vehicles.

5. Question

Scenario : Imagine a global retail company, "ShopPlus," which has been experiencing declining sales over the past two years. The company operates in multiple regions, including North America, Europe, and Asia. Despite its strong brand, ShopPlus faces intense competition, changing consumer preferences, and economic fluctuations. To address these challenges, the company's leadership decides to implement a new strategic management plan focused on digital transformation, expanding into emerging markets, and enhancing customer experience. The strategic plan includes investing in e-commerce platforms, using data analytics to understand customer behavior, launching targeted marketing campaigns, and entering new markets in Asia and Africa. The goal is to rejuvenate the brand, increase market share, and improve profitability over the next five years.

i) Do you agree that tactical management is more critical in a declining market than in a growing market?

ii) Relate the potential impact of traditional marketing versus targeted digital marketing in justifying the strategic management plan

6. Question
EcoSprout, an eco-friendly gardening supply company, has noticed a decrease in sales. To address this, they plan to enhance their online presence, collaborate with influencers, and introduce new products that cater to current environmental trends.

a) Explain the potential benefits of EcoSprout enhancing its online presence and collaborating with influencers.
b) Demonstrate two ways EcoSprout's new products can meet customer needs.

7. Question

Process mapping is a graphical representation with descriptions of how things get done. It helps the participants see the details of the process closely and guides them in decision-making. One can identify the significant strengths and weaknesses in the current process, such as the contribution of individual steps. Further, it helps to reduce the cycle times and defects in the process and improves its productivity.

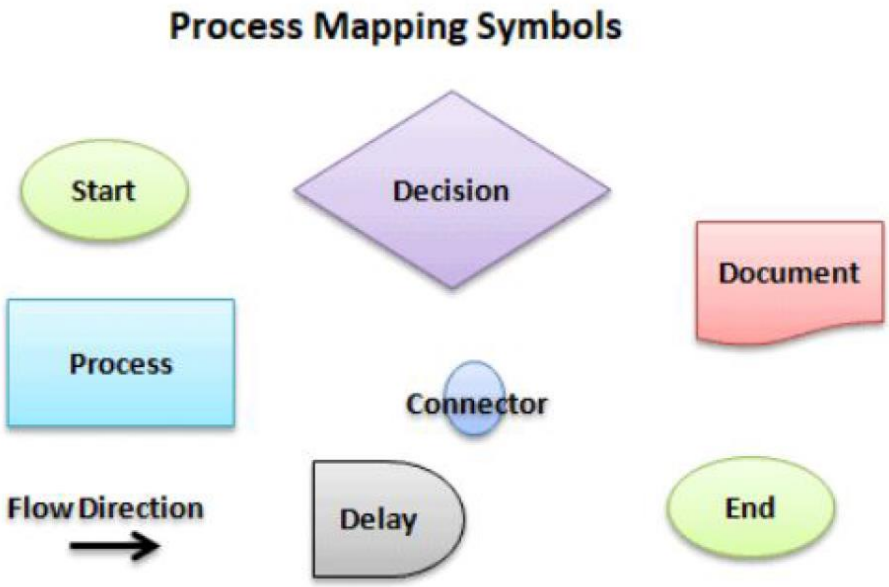


Fig: Process Mapping Symbol

Represent some common techniques for analysing process maps to identify inefficiencies or bottlenecks.

8. Question
A company deals with various kinds of products in the cleaning agents (detergents) sector. Due to workload and many product lines, the quality control manager's performance is low. The CEO wishes to appoint a qualified person who can multitask and is knowledgeable in technology. The HR is looking for a new candidate who can manage the overload of work and stress with ease. The company decides to hire an eligible person for the role of a quality control manager.

Arrange the following business process steps in the correct order for effective process management and justify it.

1. Run or implement the process
2. Test the process
3. Set actions and assign stakeholders
4. Define your goals and objectives

9. Question
Bata and Nike sell the same kind of products. But still the market share of both the companies seems to be competitive. This is due to the competitive strategies they follow. For Bata, it may be a cost leader strategy and for Nike, it may be focused on targeted customers. Yes, they both have a huge market base.

Based on the above scenario, show the correct competitive strategy followed by Nike and justify it.
a) Variety of Products
b) Various Markets
c) Using sports stars for advertising
d) Branding during cricket and football matches
e) Long life and wide range of selection

10. Question

Identify whether the following statements are True or False and justify it.

1. A company focusing on offering the lowest software products to a broad market is adopting a cost leadership strategy.
2. Differentiation involves providing unique software solutions with features that are not available in competing products.
3. A focus strategy allows a company to target a large, wide-ranging market by offering general software solutions at a lower cost.
4. Cost leadership can provide a company with the advantage of economies of scale and huge market share.

11. Question
A company deals with various kinds of products in the cleaning agents (detergents) sector. Due to workload and many product lines, the quality control manager's performance is low. So, the MD wishes to appoint a qualified person who is able to do multi-tasking and knowledgeable in the field of technology as well. The HR is looking for a new candidate who can manage the overload of work and stress at an ease. The company decides to hire an eligible person for the role of a quality control manager.

Design a Newspaper Ad for the situation.

12. Question

Process mapping is a graphical representation with descriptions of how things get done. It helps the participants see the details of the process closely and guides them in decision-making. One can identify the significant strengths and weaknesses in the current process, such as the contribution of individual steps. Further, it helps to reduce the cycle times and defects in the process and improves its productivity.

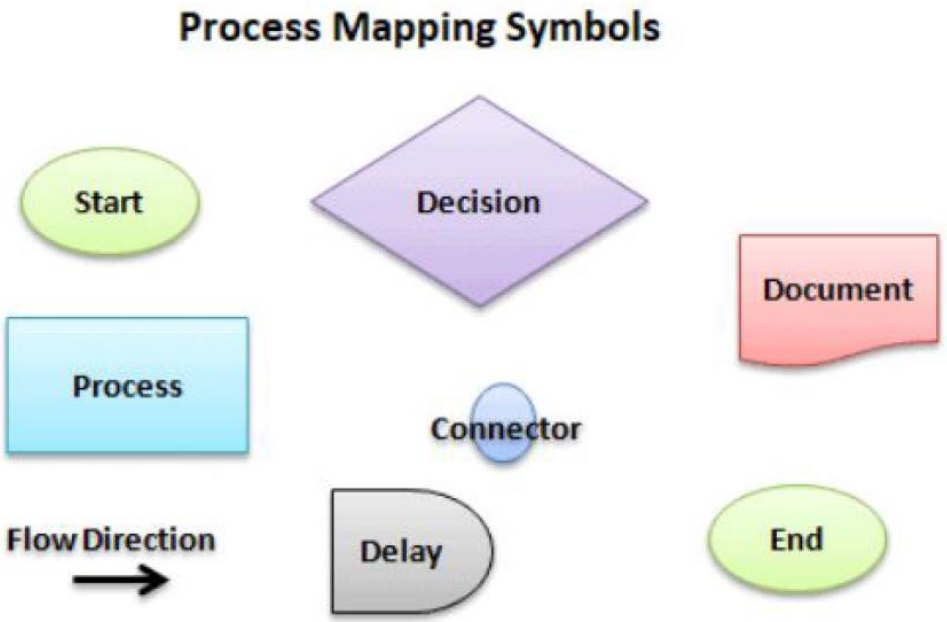


Fig: Process Mapping Symbols

Using the symbols from the image, Design a road map for a supermarket business process.

13. Question

All activities in the value chain contribute equally to a company's competitive advantage. Say yes or no and Justify the statement.

14. Question

Uber, the trailblazer in the transportation industry, has revolutionized the way people get around and explore cities. As the industry continues to evolve, it presents a dynamic mix of challenges and opportunities for Uber's growth and success.

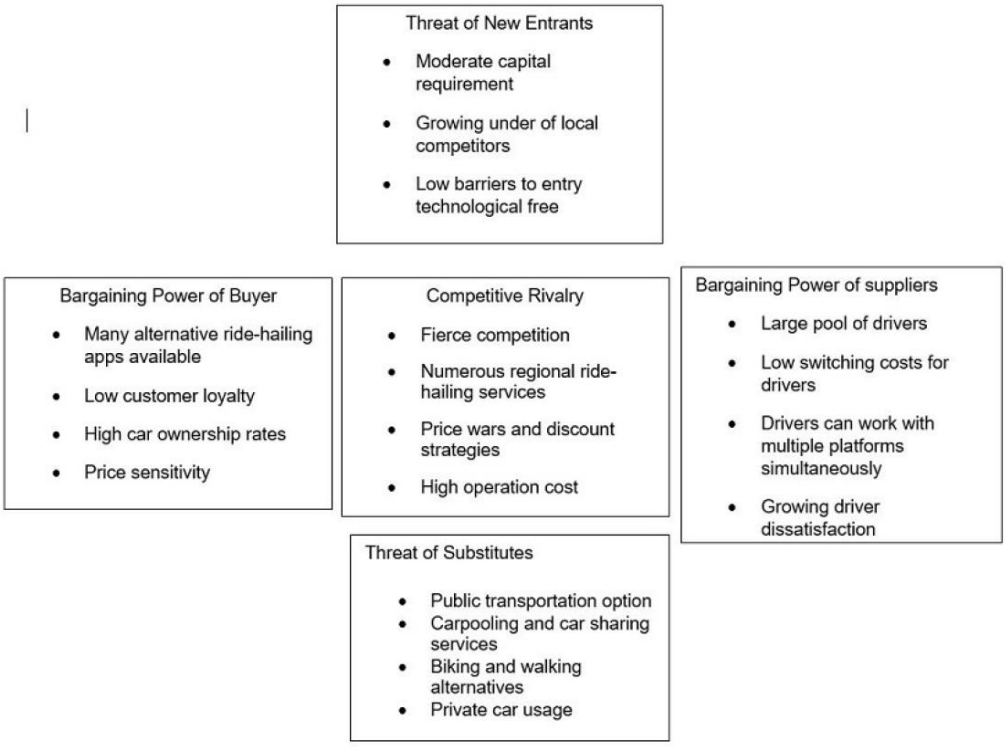


Fig: Porter's Five Forces Analysis applied to Uber

Highlight the advantages statements related to Porter's Five Forces model.

a. Organizations can gain a deep understanding of how profits are distributed among the five forces within a specific industry.
b. Insufficient effort to uncover the underlying reasons behind observations can undermine the analysis.
c. The framework is intended to inform business strategy, not merely to assess industry attractiveness.
d. The model offers business leaders a foundation to assess their company's strengths and weaknesses relative to the industry.
e. Failing to involve stakeholders during the competitive analysis may lead to avoidable obstacles.
f. Strategies often falter because managers define the competitive landscape too broadly or too narrowly.
g. The model encourages strategists to think comprehensively about industry competition and dynamics, revealing hidden opportunities for investment and growth.
h. It provides a thorough overview of an industry, highlighting critical factors that can impact a company's market position.

15. Question

Porter's value chain is a strategic tool used to analyze the activities a company performs to create value for its customers. It breaks down these activities into primary activities and support activities. By understanding the value chain, businesses can identify areas where they can create a competitive advantage.

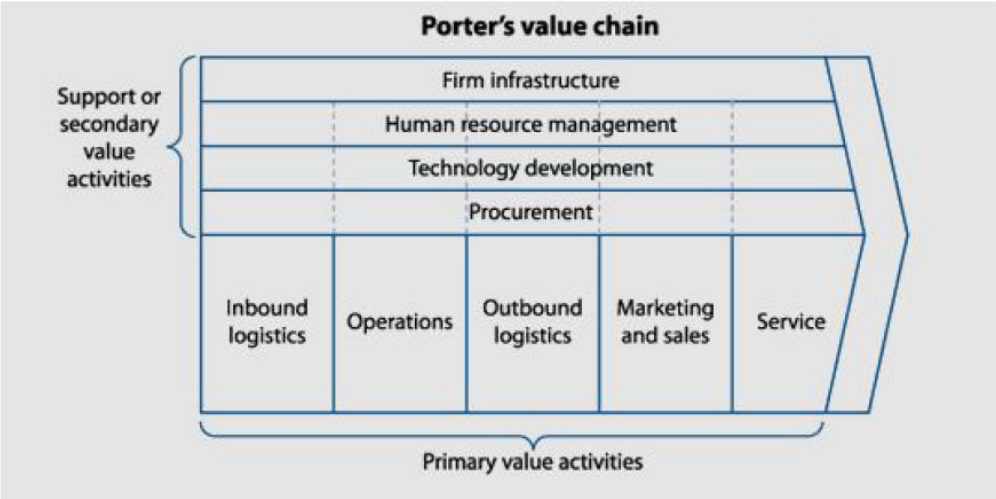


Fig: Porters Value Chain

Outline and create the primary value activities by using Porter's value chain as a framework for your own company or a hypothetical business. Explain any 3 activities that will contribute to your company's competitive advantage in the market

16. Question

The product life cycle (PLC) is the timeline of a product from its development to its removal from the market. It's a concept that helps businesses make strategic decisions about their products, including pricing, marketing, and packaging.

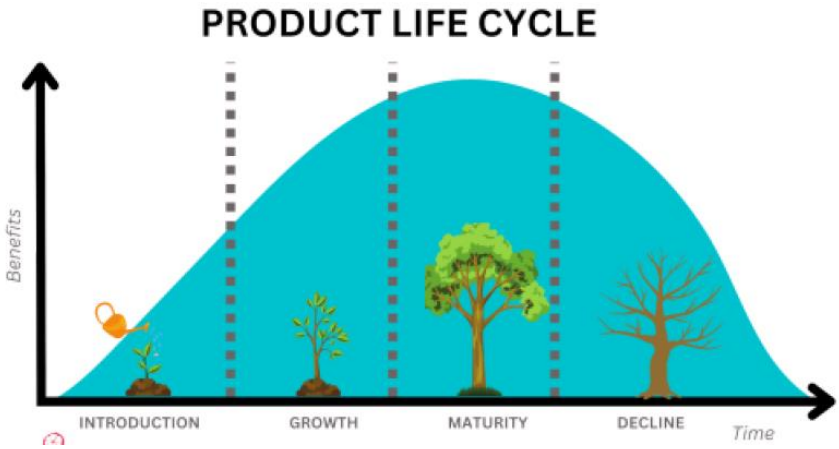


Fig: Product Life Cycle

Identify the below products that reach maturity level for more than 12 years.
a. Coco Cola
b. Dyson Airwrap
c. HP Printers
d. Zoom
e. Air Pods
f. Nintendo switch

17. Question
IKEA adopts a cost leadership strategy by offering affordable furniture through an efficient value chain. It optimizes inbound logistics by sourcing raw materials in bulk, leveraging economies of scale to reduce costs. In operations, IKEA designs flat-pack furniture, which lowers production, storage, and transportation expenses. Its streamlined manufacturing and automation also contribute to cost savings. In terms of outbound logistics, IKEA sells directly through its large global stores, bypassing intermediaries, while maintaining a cost-effective distribution network. Marketing and sales are focused on highlighting affordability, modern design, and functionality, which resonates with budget-conscious consumers. The stores double as showrooms, reducing the need for separate display spaces. Finally, IKEA's service model emphasizes self-service and DIY assembly, minimizing labour costs while maintaining customer satisfaction. In this scenario, IKEA’s cost leadership is successfully supported by a value chain focused on efficiency and cost control.

Illustrate the key steps in IKEA's value chain that contribute to its cost leadership.

18. Question
Company X is a leading player in the smartphone industry. It focuses on offering high-end smartphones with the latest features such as advanced cameras, cutting-edge design, and exclusive software capabilities. The company invests heavily in research and development and charges a premium price for its products, targeting customers who are willing to pay more for unique and advanced features.
Company Y, on the other hand, offers budget-friendly smartphones with essential features and reliable performance. The company focuses on minimizing production costs by using standardized components and automated assembly lines, which allows it to offer products at lower prices compared to its competitors.

From the above scenario, list out the strategies used by Company X and Company Y.